



Antivirus

**McAfee VirusScan 9.0/
Norton Antivirus 2005**

Our Verdict: When it comes to securing your system, you can bet your life on Antivirus solutions from Symantec and McAfee. It is hard to differentiate between the products of these two vendors, as both are great at virus detection and cleaning. When a new virus is discovered, an antidote is released within hours by both vendors.

Moreover, both products are backed by regular updates and can be updated quietly in the background. Both



require some serious system resources, however, and hence a quick glance through 'system requirements' is a must before you make that buying decision.

Runner-up: Avast antivirus (free for home use)

CD-Writing

Nero 6 Ultra Edition

Our Verdict: Nero Burning ROM has been the most popular burning software of late. The new Nero 6 Ultra Edition is a complete content creation suite. The core functions are still intact, with very few changes—mostly to the interface, which now looks jazzier. An easy and intuitive interface for beginners is retained, courtesy modules such as Nero Wave Editor for editing sound files, Nero Cover Designer to create different types of covers, inserts, etc., and

Nero Express. New features include a DVD authoring module, multi-track audio production, system backup and video capturing capabilities. We recommend Nero 6 Ultra Edition to people who want an all-in-one solution to create and burn any DVD or CD format imaginable.



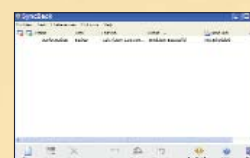
Runner-up: Easy Media Creator 7

Data Backup

SyncBack Freeware 3.2.5

Our Verdict: Digitally stored data is vulnerable—it can get wiped out due to a virus infection, hard disk crash or myriad other reasons. While there are many utilities that help you take regular backups of your work on external media, network drive or other partitions, SyncBack goes one step further and offers backup of data to an ftp server. This is quite useful as you can keep a backup on an FTP server and can work on it from any

end of the world. SyncBack offers an intuitive interface to work with, you can select between a backup profile and a synchronised profile. Both these profiles can be customised to the smallest detail. Backups can also be scheduled to happen without user intervention. Also SyncBack has a small memory footprint and hence does not hog system resources.



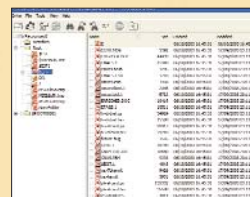
Runner-up: Second Copy 2000

Data Recovery

R-Studio 2.0

Our Verdict: R-Studio Data Recovery is comprehensive and excellent data recovery software. R-Studio 2.0 supports FAT 12 / 16 / 32, NTFS, Ext2FS (Linux) file systems and recovers files from physical disk and disk located on remote computers. R-studio can recover files even after FAT damage, MBR destruction or virus infection. To a certain extent it

can even reconstruct damaged RAID volumes. The interface is a little shoddy and requires some time to get used to, but when it comes to recovering lost files R-Studio 2.0 is something you can rely on.



Runner-up: Ontrack EasyRecovery Pro

Antivirus

Evolution: Antivirus applications are more or less unchanged from four years ago. With the proliferation of worms through email, P2P, IMs, etc., the new breed of antivirus now come with modules that scan, not only the physical drives, but inbound and outbound

mails, P2P software, IMs, etc. Apart from these primary functions, new antivirus applications are packaged with firewalls and spyware protection programs. Four years ago Norton Antivirus 2001 was the winner, and again it has proved itself to be one of the best.

